Skirmishers: A generic term applied to troops that wore no armor, rarely carried shields, and used missiles: javelinists, archers and slingers. Their role was to harass and annoy the approaching enemy and present a screen behind which, hopefully, movement could be concealed. Their mobility allowed them to outrun their weightier opponents, which, all things considered, was their best bet for survival. They rarely, if ever, shock-attacked, as they had no weapons with which to do so, and they deployed in dispersed, amorphous formations which gave them great flexibility in terms of maneuvering.